

Changing body

Puberty can be a challenging time, with the body going through many changes—both inside and out. Everybody goes through puberty, but each teen's experience is unique to them.

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◀ 30–31 Female hormones

The menstrual cycle

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Breasts

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What to expect

These are the most common changes that females experience, but they happen at different times for everyone.

▽ Child

▽ Tween

▽ Teen

▽ Adult

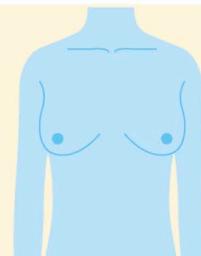
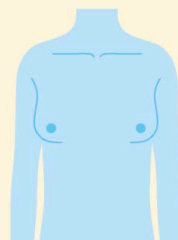
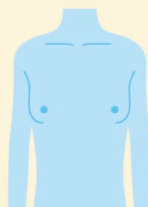
Getting taller

Growing in height is one of the first signs of puberty, beginning between the ages of 9 and 15 years. When and how much a person grows depends on the individual.



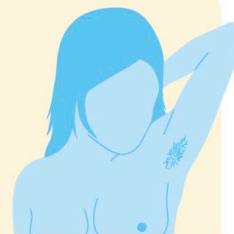
Growing breasts

Small bumps under the nipple, known as "breast buds," start to develop around 9 to 10 years old. Over time the breasts become larger and rounder.



Underarm hair

Coarser, darker hair grows under both arms. Some teens choose to remove this hair as they get older, but doing so is based on personal preference.



Wider hips and pubic hair

During puberty, the hips get wider and curvier, and the thighs gain more body fat. Pubic hair grows longer and thicker to protect the genitals.

